The Working Committee was also kept fully informed by the Provincial Congress Executive. I was always there to give them first-hand information, but, as matters were taking a serious turn, the Committee also conferred with our Provincial President, Tasadduq Sherwani, and the Allahabad District President, Purushottam Das Tandon.

The Government Agrarian Committee issued its report and made certain recommendations, which were both complicated and vague, and left a great deal to local officers. On the whole, the proposed remissions were bigger than in the past season, but we felt that they were not enough. We objected to the principles underlying the recommendations as well as to their application. Also, the report dealt with the future only and ignored past arrears, debt, and the question of the large number of dispossessed tenants. What were we to do? Just advise the peasantry to pay as much as they could, as we had done in the spring and summer, and face the same consequences? That advice, we had seen, was the most foolish of all and could not be repeated. Either the peasants should make a great effort and pay the revised demand in full, if they could at all do so, or they should not pay at all for the present and await developments. To pay part of the rent demanded was neither here nor there; the tenants exhausted their financial resources and, at the same time, lost their land.

Our Provincial Congress Executive considered the position long and earnestly and decided that the Government proposals were not favourable enough to be accepted as they were, although they were an improvement on the summer's remissions. There was still a possibility of their being varied to the peasantry's advantage, and we pressed Government accordingly. But we felt that there was little hope, and the conflict we had tried to avoid seemed to approach with some rapidity. The attitude of the Provincial Government as well as the Government of India towards the Congress organisation had been progressively changing and becoming more frigid. To our long letters we received brief replies referring us to local officials. It was obvious that the policy of Government was not to encourage us in any way. One grievance and difficulty of the Government was the possibility of Congress prestige going up because of the grant of remissions to the peasantry. Through long habit, it could only think in terms of prestige, and the idea that the masses might give the credit for the remissions to the Congress irritated it, and it wanted to avoid this as far as possible.